

Book Recommendation Datasets

Complete Guide

Top Publicly Available Datasets

1. Book Recommendation Dataset (Most Popular) ■■■■

Source: Kaggle

URL: <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/arashnic/book-recommendation-dataset>

Downloads: 40K+

Files Included:

- **books.csv** - Book metadata
- **users.csv** - User information
- **ratings.csv** - User ratings

Sample Size:

- Books: ~271,000 books
- Users: ~278,000 users
- Ratings: ~1.1 million ratings

2. Books Dataset ■■

Source: Kaggle

URL: <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/abdallahwagih/books-dataset>

Description: Books dataset for recommendation systems and chatbots (~50,000 books)

3. Book Recommendation Dataset with Genres ■■■■

Source: Kaggle

URL: <https://www.kaggle.com/datasets/sohammhatre10/book-recommendation-dataset-with-genres>

Includes book metadata, user ratings, and **genre information** (bonus!)

How to Download from Kaggle

Method 1: Direct Download (Easiest)

1. Go to the dataset URL
2. Click 'Download' button
3. Extract the CSV files

Method 2: Kaggle API (For Scripts)

```
pip install kaggle
```

```
kaggle datasets download -d arashnic/book-recommendation-dataset
```

```
unzip book-recommendation-dataset.zip
```

Method 3: Via Python (In Your Notebook)

```
from kaggle.api.kaggle_api_extended import KaggleApi
api = KaggleApi()
api.authenticate()
api.dataset_download_files('arashnic/book-recommendation-dataset', path='.', unzip=True)
```

Dataset Columns (Main Dataset)

books.csv columns:

ISBN, Book-Title, Book-Author, Year-Of-Publication, Publisher, Image-URL-S, Image-URL-M, Image-URL-L

ratings.csv columns:

User-ID, ISBN, Book-Rating

users.csv columns:

User-ID, Location, Age

Dataset Comparison

Dataset	Size	Type	Best For
Book Recommendation Dataset	271K books 1.1M ratings	CSV	Collaborative Filtering
Books Dataset	50K books	CSV	Basic Recommendations
With Genres	Unknown	CSV	Genre-based Filtering
BookCrossing	271K books 1.1M ratings	CSV	Research & Benchmarks

Using Real Dataset in Your Notebook

Step 1: Load the Real Kaggle Dataset

```
from langchain_community.document_loaders import CSVLoader
loader = CSVLoader(file_path='books.csv')
documents = loader.load()
```

Step 2: Handle Encoding (Important!)

```
The Kaggle dataset uses 'latin-1' encoding:
pd.read_csv('books.csv', encoding='latin-1')
```

Step 3: Sample for Speed (Optional)

```
The full dataset is large. Sample top books:
books = pd.read_csv('books.csv', encoding='latin-1')
top_books = books.head(1000) # Use top 1000 books
top_books.to_csv('books_sample.csv', index=False)
```

Troubleshooting

Issue: Module kaggle not found

```
pip install kaggle
```

Issue: Kaggle authentication failed

1. Go to: <https://www.kaggle.com/settings/account>
2. Download API token (kaggle.json)
3. Place in: ~/.kaggle/kaggle.json
4. Run: `chmod 600 ~/.kaggle/kaggle.json` (Mac/Linux)

Issue: Encoding errors

```
Use latin-1 encoding: pd.read_csv('books.csv', encoding='latin-1')
```

Issue: File too large

```
Sample the dataset: df = pd.read_csv('books.csv', nrows=5000, encoding='latin-1')
```

My Recommendation

For your LangChain book recommendation notebook, I suggest:

1. Download: 'Book Recommendation Dataset' from Kaggle (arashnic)
2. Sample: Use top 2000-5000 books to keep processing fast
3. Update: Replace the sample CSV in your notebook
4. Extend: Add columns like `average_rating`, `publication_year`

This will give you a much more realistic and interesting system with real book data! ■

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